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Roles:

- Narrator 1
- Narrator 2
- Mika
- Eli

Part 1

Narrator 1:
Mika, 24, is a contract designer. Eli, 25, works rotating support shifts. After three years together, most dates still happen between long commutes.

Mika: By the time I get home, you're leaving for work. I want us to have a normal dinner, not just messages saying we miss each other

Eli: This room is closer to both jobs. We could share rent and groceries - and still send money home. But I want this because I want to be with you too.

Mika: I want that. I'm not ready for a wedding or children yet. Can we live together without pretending those decisions are already made?

Eli: Yes. I do hope we'll marry someday. Let's talk about what "someday" means instead of assuming we mean the same thing.

Narrator: They move in unmarried. Sharing costs matters, but so do affection, independence, and learning what everyday partnership asks of them.

Part 2

Narrator: For a while, they make the schedules work. Eli leaves breakfast before sleeping; Mika packs his dinner before her own deadlines.

Mika: Lately I'm cooking, tracking the bills, and reminding you what we need. I'm tired too. I don't want to become the manager of our home.

Eli: My shifts changed, and I'm helping with my brother's school fees. But I used being tired as a reason to leave everything else to you. I'm sorry.

Mika: I’m not asking you to stop helping your family. I’m asking us to decide what we can both carry, instead of letting it fall to whoever notices first.

Eli: Let’s put the chores and expenses where we can both see them. I’ll handle the groceries and laundry. We’ll protect one evening a week for us.

Narrator: The chart helps. For the next few months they try to share care more fairly. Repair is possible—but practical agreements cannot answer every question about a future.

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Music transition: The problem is not a single unwashed plate. It is the feeling of becoming the only person who notices what the home needs.

Demographic lens: Household well-being · division of care.

Part 3: They meant different things by “later”

Month 6 · The plans beneath the plans

Narrator: Six months in, the dishes are no longer the main issue. Mika’s contract will end later in the year. She starts applying for stable work in Iloilo, near her family.

Mika: If I get the job, I want to take it. I also want a few years to build my career. I’m still unsure whether I want children.

Eli: I thought we were saving for a wedding, then a family here. My work is here, and my brother still needs me nearby. I didn’t realize your picture was that different.

Mika: When I said “later,” I meant I hadn’t decided. You heard a promise with a date attached. I should have made that clearer.

Eli: I should have asked. Moving in felt like we were already on the same path, so I stopped checking where each of us actually wanted to go.

Narrator: Neither plan is wrong. But avoiding the difference makes the home lonelier. They still share an address while important conversations become messages left unanswered.

Music transition: A chore chart can divide tasks. It cannot make two people want the same future. The songs now turn from repair toward limits and emotional distance.

Demographic lens: Life course · expectations · linked lives.

Part 4: An ending they do not rush

Month 9 · After trying to repair

Narrator: They keep the weekly conversations for three more months. Some days feel close again. Then Mika receives the Iloilo offer, and they have to stop treating their future as a distant question.

Eli: Could we try living apart for work? I don't want to call this over just because a job is in another city.

Mika: We could manage the distance. But it wouldn't settle marriage or children. I can't ask you to wait for a promise I may never be able to make.

Eli: And I can't stay while quietly expecting you to change your mind. That would turn every good thing between us into something we're bargaining with.

Mika: Then let's not renew the lease together. We can love what we built and still accept that we can't keep building the same life.

Narrator: They choose to end the relationship when the lease ends. This is their response to persistent differences after trying to repair—not a rule about what every couple should do.

Music transition: They both wish there were a way to stay without asking the other person to become someone else. True Love Waits gives that attachment a voice; Don't Think Twice, It's All Right then holds hesitation beside the choice to leave.

Demographic lens: Union dissolution · agency.

Part 5: Leaving is also a practical task

Month 12 · The lease ends

Narrator: At the end of the lease, there are final bills, a deposit, and belongings neither person can pretend are only sentimental. They make a list before they start packing.

Mika: The deposit came from both of us. Let's settle the utilities first, then divide what's left. I'll take the desk; you keep the table you brought from home.

Eli: My cousin has room while I save for another place near work. You'll stay with your family until the new job starts. We don't have to solve the whole next year tonight.

Mika: I'll miss you. But let's give each other space instead of acting like nothing changed every time one of us feels lonely.

Eli: You were good to me in ways I didn't always notice. I'm sorry for that. I can be grateful without asking you to stay.

Narrator: They return the key. Two people have not disappeared from the population; a shared household has changed, and their relatives now become part of each person's support network.

Music transition: They are packing more than objects. They are releasing the apartment, the routines, and the future they once pictured together. Gratitude and grief can remain after the decision is made.

Demographic lens: Household reorganization · support networks.

Part 6: Two addresses, unfinished feelings

Six months later · Separate lives

Narrator: Six months later, Mika is working in Iloilo. Eli is still in Metro Manila. They have new routines, but neither person feels completely fine on a neat schedule.

Eli: Some days I say I'm doing great. Then I start a message to you and remember that missing someone isn't the same as having a different answer to what ended us.

Mika: The plant from our window is beside my new desk. I'm glad I took this job. I still miss the evenings when the apartment felt like ours.

Narrator: They moved in for love, more time, and a manageable shared life. They left after repair revealed different plans they could not honestly promise to one another.

Narrator: They were not married, so this story is about cohabitation and the end of a union. It should not be counted as a legal divorce.

Narrator: Their story opens a wider question for our closing discussion: when a marriage can no longer be sustained, what choices and support should help people leave with dignity?

Music transition: The closing songs move through bravado, memory, changed plans, and growth. Their new addresses arrive before every feeling catches up.

Demographic lens: Post-separation adjustment · life course.